

UPSTRIDE RESOURCES

FREE PRACTICAL DIGITAL GROWTH SERIES

Website Development Playbook

Plan and build a website that explains, proves, and converts.

A business-first guide to strategy, content, UX, development, launch, and continuous improvement.

STRATEGY > SYSTEM > SCALE

YOUR NEXT STEP FORWARD

How to use this playbook

A business-first guide to strategy, content, UX, development, launch, and continuous improvement.

**READ**

Understand the operating model.

**ASSESS**

Score your current state honestly.

**BUILD**

Complete one focused pilot.

**REVIEW**

Use evidence to improve the system.

A note on responsible use

This free publication is for educational and planning purposes. Adapt every recommendation to your business, customers, contracts, privacy obligations, security requirements, and local laws. It is not legal, financial, accounting, cybersecurity, or regulatory advice. Product and platform capabilities change; verify current requirements before implementation.



BASELINE

Where are you now?

Rate each statement from 1 (not true yet) to 5 (consistently true). Use the lowest scores to choose your first improvement.

01 We have a shared definition of success for clarify.

1 2 3 4 5

02 The current workflow and ownership are documented and understood.

1 2 3 4 5

03 Our tools and data have clear sources of truth.

1 2 3 4 5

04 Important exceptions are identified and assigned to a person.

1 2 3 4 5

05 We measure outcomes, quality, and adoption - not only activity.

1 2 3 4 5

06 The team reviews and improves the system on a regular cadence.

1 2 3 4 5

YOUR BASELINE SCORE

6-14 START | 15-23 STABILIZE | 24-30 SCALE



THE UPSTRIDE FRAMEWORK

Five moves that build momentum

Use this sequence to move from a scattered effort to a visible, repeatable system.

01**CLARIFY**

Set the direction and desired outcome.

02**STRUCTURE**

Remove ambiguity and unnecessary friction.

03**DESIGN**

Create the core workflow and supporting assets.

04**BUILD**

Launch with ownership, controls, and visibility.

05**OPTIMIZE**

Learn from evidence and strengthen the system.

CLARIFY IN PRACTICE

Clarify the job of the site

Define the audience, decision, and business outcome before discussing pages or effects.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Choose one primary conversion goal

Choose one primary conversion goal.

2

Write a one-sentence value proposition

Write a one-sentence value proposition.

3

List the proof visitors need to proceed

List the proof visitors need to proceed.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?

STRUCTURE IN PRACTICE

Create the content structure

A clear information hierarchy helps visitors find meaning before visual polish is added.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Map pages to visitor questions

Map pages to visitor questions.

2

Use descriptive navigation labels

Use descriptive navigation labels.

3

Create reusable content patterns

Create reusable content patterns.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?

DESIGN IN PRACTICE

Design for confidence

Typography, spacing, imagery, and interaction should reinforce credibility and ease.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Prioritize readable mobile layouts

Prioritize readable mobile layouts.

2

Make every action and state understandable

Make every action and state understandable.

3

Use motion to guide, never to distract

Use motion to guide, never to distract.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?

BUILD IN PRACTICE

Build for quality

Semantic code, responsive behavior, accessibility, SEO, and performance are product requirements.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Test keyboard and screen-reader basics

Test keyboard and screen-reader basics.

2

Optimize images and loading behavior

Optimize images and loading behavior.

3

Create useful error and empty states

Create useful error and empty states.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?

OPTIMIZE IN PRACTICE

Launch and improve

A launch is the beginning of measurement, maintenance, and content refinement.

OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Make the next right action obvious, owned, and measurable.

Three actions to take

1

Verify forms, analytics, metadata, and redirects

Verify forms, analytics, metadata, and redirects.

2

Monitor real visitor paths

Monitor real visitor paths.

3

Schedule content and dependency reviews

Schedule content and dependency reviews.

DECISION PROMPT

What would become easier for the customer or the team if this part of the system worked reliably every time?

MOVE FROM IDEA TO PILOT

A focused implementation sprint

Keep the first implementation narrow enough to learn quickly and important enough to matter.

1

Define audience and conversion

DAYS 1-3

2

Approve sitemap and page goals

DAYS 4-7

3

Draft message hierarchy

DAYS 8-11

4

Prototype key journeys

DAYS 12-16

5

Build reusable components

DAYS 17-21

6

Run quality checks

DAYS 22-26

7

Launch and review behavior

DAYS 27-30



MAKE IT CONCRETE

One-page system brief

Complete this before selecting tools or building assets. Short, specific answers are more useful than broad ambition.

01 PRIMARY AUDIENCE

02 MAIN VISITOR QUESTION

03 PRIMARY CONVERSION

04 REQUIRED PROOF

05 KEY INTEGRATIONS

06 LAUNCH OWNER AND REVIEW CADENCE



EVIDENCE OVER ACTIVITY

A practical scorecard

Choose a small set of measures that show customer value, operational quality, and sustainable adoption.

MEASURE	BASELINE	TARGET	CADENCE
Qualified inquiries			
Conversion rate			
Task completion			
Core Web Vitals			
Search visibility			

REVIEW QUESTION

What changed, why did it change, and what will we do next?



READY TO MOVE FORWARD?

Final readiness check

A healthy launch has clarity, ownership, safeguards, measurement, and a defined next review.

- ☐ The desired business and customer outcome is specific.
- ☐ A named owner is accountable for the system.
- ☐ The normal workflow and important exceptions are documented.
- ☐ Data access, privacy, and security requirements are reviewed.
- ☐ Users have been trained in the real workflow.
- ☐ Success measures have baselines, targets, and owners.
- ☐ A rollback or recovery path exists where needed.
- ☐ The first improvement review is scheduled.

YOUR NEXT STEP FORWARD

Continue with Website Development Specialist.

See the guided learning path: upstride-three.vercel.app/academy/website-development

FREE GUIDE TO GUIDED PRACTICE

Ready to build the skill?

This playbook gives you the framework. The matching Upstride Academy program helps you apply it through structured lessons, practical projects, downloadable tools, and a capstone.

RECOMMENDED PROGRAM

Website Development Specialist

UPSTRIDE ACADEMY | PRACTICAL, PROJECT-BASED LEARNING

What the program helps you do

1

Turn business goals into site architecture

Turn business goals into site architecture through guided exercises and feedback-ready project work.

2

Design and build responsive user journeys

Design and build responsive user journeys through guided exercises and feedback-ready project work.

3

Complete a production-ready website capstone

Complete a production-ready website capstone through guided exercises and feedback-ready project work.

CHOOSE YOUR SUPPORT LEVEL

Basic | Pro | Mentored

Review current package details and availability on the course page before enrolling.

View the program and enroll

upstride-three.vercel.app/academy/website-development